

Jim Crane

On-Chain Artist | Creative Technologist | Sound Systems & Digital Archives

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PROFILE

Artist, sound engineer and creative technologist working with music, provenance, archives and blockchain-native media. My current practice asks how creative origin material - loops, stems, credits, metadata, interviews, code, prompts and project history - can become part of the artwork rather than hidden production residue. I build systems that make cultural process legible: on-chain music tools, Bitcoin-based rights and credit experiments, artist-led media formats, and AI-assisted workflows for turning messy creative datasets into structured public artefacts.

PRACTICE FOCUS

- On-chain music, provenance and authorship
- Creative archives, source material and metadata
- Bitcoin, Stacks, inscriptions and NFT history
- Generative audio systems and loop libraries
- Artist interviews, public research and documentation
- AI-assisted media production and workflow automation
- Sound design for performance, installation and broadcast
- Cultural infrastructure for independent musicians

SELECTED PROJECTS

Founder and Developer | This Is Number One / Audionals | 2020-present

- Created This Is Number One, the first NFT marketplace on the Stacks blockchain, launching early commercial and music NFT collections and helping define an initial Stacks creative economy.
- Founded Audionals, a Bitcoin-based music protocol exploring transparent credits, rights, provenance and reusable creative components.
- Developing KP Loops with Kieron Pepper (The Prodigy): an on-chain drum loop library that treats stems, loops, credits and usage history as native cultural data.
- Collaborated with or supported projects involving Fatboy Slim, Orbital, Cara Delevingne, Dave Stewart (Eurythmics), Chemical X and other artists at the edge of music, web3 and media.

Presenter and Producer | The Audionals Show | 2023-present

- Created, hosted and produced a long-form interview series on on-chain music, sound design, Bitcoin culture and creative technology.
- Built a public research archive through 40+ live and recorded episodes, combining conversation, documentation, technical production and community memory.
- Directed audio, video, live-streaming and publishing workflows, turning ephemeral discussion into accessible media assets for a distributed creative community.

Creative Technologist | AI and Audio Workflow Systems | 2024-present

- Designed automation tools that reduced a publisher's audiobook production workflow from roughly 8 hours to 6 minutes, translating unstructured text and media tasks into repeatable pipelines.
- Use AI tools in practice as collaborators for research, prototyping, editing, compression, media structuring and rapid iteration, with attention to authorship, traceability and human judgement.

Sound and Lighting Designer / Technician | THEY / ONLAR by Ipek Duben, Fabrica Gallery | 2017

- Designed and deployed directional speaker systems, multi-zone playback and sensor-driven interactivity for an immersive installation context.

LIVE PRODUCTION AND SOUND BACKGROUND

Tour Manager, Front of House and Monitor Engineer | Freelance | 2006-2019

- Managed international tours across multiple continents for artists including Palma Violets, The Go! Team, The Big Moon, Kelis, Tom Waits and others.
- Led technical and touring teams of up to 15 crew, balancing logistics, budgets, artist care and high-pressure creative delivery.
- This live practice informs my digital work: I understand music as a social, technical and logistical system, not just a finished file.

Sound Engineer and Technician | Brighton Dome & Festival | 2002-present

- Delivered sound, stage and technical support across music, theatre, dance, comedy, festivals and outdoor arts.
- Worked with visiting artists and production companies to realise complex technical requirements in major cultural venues.

Monitor Engineer | Krankenhaus Festival, Muncaster | 2025

- Provided monitor engineering and stage sound management for a multi-day independent arts and music festival founded by Sea Power.

Additional Selected Production Credits | BBC, ITV, Glastonbury Festival, Brighton Festival | 2002-2012

- Moving light technician for Later... with Jools Holland and The Jonathan Ross Show; stage crew on Glastonbury's Jazz World / One World stage; audio system designer and lead PA engineer for a quadraphonic Brighton Festival project featuring Irvine Welsh and Longrange.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

- Diploma in Audio Engineering - School of Audio Engineers, Sydney, Australia
- Diploma in Performing Arts - The Actors Centre, Sydney, Australia
- Ongoing self-directed study in blockchain development, AI-assisted production, generative audio, inscriptions, creative metadata and decentralised cultural infrastructure.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Imported the UK's first two-way Bitcoin ATM in 2014, reflecting a long-term interest in decentralised systems before web3 became a mainstream art discourse.
- Pioneered the first NFTs on the Stacks network in 2021 and helped establish early models for Bitcoin-adjacent creative publishing.
- Developed Xtrata and related experiments around recursive inscriptions, on-chain media, provenance graphs and persistent cultural records.
- Combines hands-on music production craft with code, blockchain systems, AI tooling and public-facing artist documentation.

LINKS

Audionals: <https://audionals.com>

KP Loops: <https://audionals.com/BAM/kp-loops>

X / Twitter: <https://x.com/jimdotbtc>